Chapter 3

# A Letter to Grandma

Ravi is ten years old. He lives in Mumbai with his parents. His grandmother lives in a small village near Mysuru in Karnataka. Grandma does not use a mobile phone, so Ravi writes letters to her.

Last month, Ravi had some happy news. He won the first prize in his school's drawing competition. He had drawn a picture of Grandma's village with its green paddy fields and a big banyan tree. Ravi wanted to tell Grandma about the prize, to thank her for the warm sweater she had knitted for him, and to invite her to his birthday. So he sat down to write a letter. This is what he wrote:

Dear Grandma,
I hope you are well. I have wonderful news! I won the first prize in the drawing competition. I drew your village, with the banyan tree near the temple. Thank you for the blue sweater. I wear it every morning on my way to school. My birthday is on the 12th of next month. Please come and stay with us. Mother will make your favourite payasam.
With love,
Ravi

Ravi folded the letter, put it in an envelope and wrote Grandma's address on it, with the six-digit PIN code. Then he stuck a stamp on the envelope.

## How a letter travels

Ravi dropped his letter into the red post box near his school. In the evening, a postman opened the post box and took all the letters to the post office.

At the post office, the letters were sorted, which means they were put into groups according to where they had to go. The PIN code helped the workers find the right group quickly. PIN stands for Postal Index Number. India started using PIN codes in 1972.

Ravi's letter travelled by train to Karnataka. Then a mail van took it to the small post office near Grandma's village. The next morning, the village postman rode his bicycle to Grandma's house and gave her the letter.

Grandma read the letter twice and smiled. She wrote back the same day: "My dear Ravi, I am so proud of you. I will come for your birthday and bring you a jar of mango pickle."

## Let's talk

1. Why did Ravi write a letter to his grandmother?
2. What does PIN stand for?
3. Name the different people who helped Ravi's letter reach Grandma.

## New words

envelope - a paper cover in which we put a letter
sorted - arranged into groups